

cent lesser power than the Gekko processor of the Nintendo GameCube, which was also designed by IBM.

With the core clock running at just 729 MHz, the Wii is barely as fast as the original Xbox, whose processor clocked in at 733 MHz. Based on the IBM's silicon-on-insulator Power Architecture, it provides impressive processing power without consuming much energy.

Hollywood GPU

If there was little information available about the Broadway processor, there is even less about the ATI-produced graphics processing unit (GPU), dubbed the Hollywood.

IGN.com was among the few who found out any details about this ultra-secretive GPU, when a source from a game developer studio told them: "The 'Hollywood' is a large-scale 90nm integrated chip that includes the GPU, DSP, I/O bridge and 3MBs of texture memory."

Further information has leaked that it clocks in at 243 MHz. By comparison, GameCube's GPU ran at 162 MHz, while the GPU on the original Xbox was clocked at 233 MHz.

The internal memory of the device includes 3 MB of embedded graphics memory and 24 MB of high speed main memory. Externally, the device uses just 64 MB of DDR3 memory.

By any modern standards, this is not a device that can churn out awe-inspiring visuals at super-high resolutions.

But the Wii was never meant for that anyway, after all. The Wii is all about fun, not about setting new graphics benchmarks.



The 'Hollywood' processor and the 'Broadway' GPU are nothing to write home about. But the Wii is not about the graphics and computing muscle anyway; it's all about fun

DVD-ROM

The Wii utilises a simple, slot-loading DVD-ROM as its optical drive. The illuminated drive accepts both Wii DVDs as well as GameCube game disks.

Given the low graphic requirements of the Wii, most of the games designed